

Board 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5 2
♥ A 9 8
♦ K 5 2
♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A 10 9 4
♥ K Q J 7
♦ Q 6
♣ A Q 4



♠ Q 8 3
♥ 6 4 3
♦ 10 8 7 3
♣ 6 5 3

♠ J 7 6
♥ 10 5 2
♦ A J 9 4
♣ K 10 2

NORTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has good strength in WEST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

NORTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 7 5
♥ K 10 7 6
♦ 10 9 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 4

♣ J 10 7



♠ J 3 2

♥ 8 4 3

♦ Q 8 5 3

♣ K 6 2

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 2

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 9 8 3

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

1 ♠

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

NORTH has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But WEST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

SOUTH also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting NORTH to bid game.

Since NORTH has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 6 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ 9 4 2

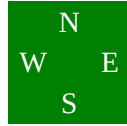
♣ 9 3 2

♠ A 9 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6



♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 10 7 6

♣ 10 7 5

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4

SOUTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, NORTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to SOUTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for NORTH - he bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
		1♠	Dbl
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

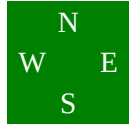
Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ Q J 10 4
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ K Q 10 5

♠ K 7 5
 ♥ 8 5 2
 ♦ K Q 3
 ♣ 9 7 6 2



♠ 10 9
 ♥ K 9 6 3
 ♦ 10 8 6 5
 ♣ J 4 3

♠ A Q J 6 4 2
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ J 7 2
 ♣ A 8

There is only one reason that SOUTH should not overcall with 1 ♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So SOUTH doubles, and after NORTH bids 2 ♣, SOUTH bids 2 ♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

NORTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 5 4
 ♥ J 10 9 2
 ♦ J 10 8 6
 ♣ 5 3

♠ Q J 2
 ♥ A K 4 3
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ K Q 8 2



♠ A 7 6
 ♥ Q 8 5
 ♦ A 9 3 2
 ♣ 10 9 4

♠ K 9 8 3
 ♥ 7 6
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A J 7 6

SOUTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1 ♦.

NORTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

SOUTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

NORTH shows his ♥ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows her ♠ suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows his ♣ suit, SOUTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5♣.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♦	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 7 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 5

♠ Q 5 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ 10 3 2

♣ A J 7 4



♠ 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ J 7 5 4

♣ K 10 6 2

♠ K 8 2

♥ K J 10 2

♦ K Q 9

♣ Q 8 3

WEST would have had a great opening 1♠ bid. But when SOUTH opened 1♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South